This is a favorite soup in Portugal, where fresh cilantro is used enthusiastically. It is essentially a potato and onion soup, blended with lots of fresh cilantro.

potato and cilantro soup

SERVES 4–6 **PREP** 10–15 MINS **COOK** 30 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS

1 small bunch of fresh cilantro
2 onions, chopped
2 cloves garlic, chopped
3 tbsp olive oil
2lb (900g) potatoes, peeled and cubed
2 pints (1.2 litres) chicken stock, vegetable stock or water
salt and pepper

1 Cut the stems from the cilantro and tie them in a bundle with string. Chop the leaves finely and reserve.

2 Cook the onion and garlic gently in the oil until tender without browning. Add the potatoes and cilantro stems, stir, then cover and cook over low heat for 5 minutes.

3 Now add the stock, salt, and pepper and bring to a boil. Simmer until the potatoes are very tender. Remove the bundle of cilantro stems. Process in a blender, adding a little more stock or water if the soup is too thick. Stir in the cilantro leaves and reheat gently without boiling. Taste and adjust the seasoning. Serve immediately.



USING CILANTRO
You can easily grow hardy cilantro in a pot on your windowsill. Cook it, eat it raw, or use it as a garnish. Cut bunches should be kept in water or in a sealed pack in the refrigerator, but make sure you use them within a week.